

GAMING LAPTOPS

MSI showcases RTX Spark laptops, Claw 8 EX handheld and much more

At its 40th-anniversary Computex 2026 showcase, MSI pushed gaming hardware beyond raw performance, leading with the Prestige N16 Flip AI+, its first laptop powered by Nvidia RTX Spark, a creator-focused 2-in-1 with a 16-inch OLED, stylus support, and on-device AI for image generation, coding, and video work. The



collector-oriented Titan 18 HX Dragon Edition celebrates the milestone with metal etching and a Draco-constellation theme, signalling gaming's drift into lifestyle territory.

MSI also displayed the Claw 8 EX AI+, billed as the world's first handheld with Intel Arc G3 Extreme graphics. Other reveals included the Prestige 14 Flip AI+ Van Gogh Edition and refreshed Katana laptops with RTX 5070 GPUs. The new Venture productivity series and white Crosshair 16 HX MLG Edition rounded out the lineup.

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LAPTOP DESIGN

Asus explains why the ROG Zephyrus Duo got a full second screen

At a Taipei briefing on the eve of Computex 2026, Asus explained why the 2026 ROG Zephyrus Duo swapped its small secondary display for a full second screen and detachable keyboard. ROG's Andrean Tean said gamers use the main screen for play and the second for YouTube, Instagram, or creative apps like Photoshop, making the full panel far more useful than the older 1.5-size display. Designer Jo Wen added that research showed gamers constantly multitask, streaming, chatting, and looking up guides, and that the foldable design even lets two people use it at once. The laptop packs up to an Nvidia RTX 5090, making it one of the most powerful portable gaming machines available right now. Guided by its Simple Made Meaningful philosophy and Ceraluminum materials, Asus said it is watching rollable laptops closely but considers the cost still too high for most users to justify at this stage.



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Handheld consoles get an upgrade at Computex 2026: what's new from Asus, MSI

Computex made clear that portable gaming PCs have become the show's headline act, with Asus and MSI leading the charge. MSI's redemption arc came via the Claw 8 EX AI+ in a Void Purple casing, powered by Intel's Arc G3 Extreme processor with a large 8-inch FHD+ 120Hz VRR screen, driftless Hall-effect joysticks, and a user-accessible M.2 2280 SSD slot that makes storage upgrades

genuinely painless. Asus countered with the premium ROG Xbox Ally X20, featuring a striking black-and-translucent chassis



with gold accents, a 7.4-inch Nebula HDR OLED panel at 1,400 nits, AMD's Ryzen AI Z2 Extreme, and 24GB RAM. Both devices signal that handhelds are no longer secondary companions but fully-fledged flagship devices deserving serious attention. The golden age of portable gaming, the article argues, has officially and emphatically arrived.

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